

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET A — FOUNDATION & CORE CONCEPTS****CHAPTER 06: DEMOCRACY**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-A-06

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET A - Foundation & Core Concepts):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
3. Each question offers four options: **(A), (B), (C), and (D)**. Select the single best answer.
4. Darken the corresponding circle on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

Q.1 What is the most widely accepted classic definition of democracy formulated by Abraham Lincoln?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Government of the people, by the people, and for the people | (B) Rule by a hereditary monarch without public accountability |
| (C) Government controlled exclusively by military commanders | (D) Rule by the wealthiest corporation in a country |

Q.2 In a true democracy, who holds the ultimate authority to make major national policy decisions?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Leaders elected by the citizens through free and fair elections | (B) Unelected military generals and intelligence heads |
| (C) Hereditary monarchs and foreign diplomats | (D) Judges appointed for life without constitutional boundaries |

Q.3 Which of the following is an indispensable condition for an election to be considered truly 'democratic'?

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|--|--|
| (A) Elections must offer a real choice and the ruling party must have a fair chance of losing | (B) Only members of the ruling party are allowed on the ballot |
| (C) The head of state can alter election results if unsatisfied | (D) Voting is restricted exclusively to landowners and billionaires |

Q.4 The democratic principle of 'Universal Adult Franchise' implies that:

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Every adult citizen has the right to vote, and each vote has one equal value ('One Person, One Vote, One Value') | (B) Only university graduates are granted voting rights |
| (C) Wealthy taxpayers receive ten votes each while poor citizens receive none | (D) Men are permitted to vote but women are excluded |

Q.5 A democratic government cannot do whatever it likes simply because it has won an election. It must rule within limits set by:

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Constitutional law and respect for citizens' fundamental rights | (B) The personal whims of the prime minister |
| (C) Orders issued by international corporations | (D) Unchecked royal decrees |

Q.6 Which of the following historical cases represents a NON-DEMOCRATIC system?

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|--|--|
| (A) General Pervez Musharraf's military takeover in Pakistan in 1999 where real power lay with military officers | (B) A country where regular periodic elections replace ruling parties through peaceful ballots |
| (C) A nation where independent courts protect opposition speech | (D) A state where universal adult franchise ensures equal voting rights |

Q.7 In China, although elections are held regularly for the National People's Congress, why is the system NOT considered truly democratic?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Only candidates approved by the Chinese Communist Party are allowed to contest | (B) China has no constitution or parliament |
| (C) Citizens are not allowed to read books | (D) Voting machines are completely prohibited |

Q.8 Why was the Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) in Mexico from 1930 to 2000 criticized as non-democratic despite holding elections every six years?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) The PRI used electoral fraud, pressured civil servants, controlled media, and moved polling booths to rig outcomes | (B) Mexico had no citizens living within its borders |
| (C) The president declared himself king for life | (D) Elections were held without ballot papers |

Q.9 Until 2015, which country denied women the right to vote in municipal elections?

- | | |
|-------------------|------------|
| (A) Saudi Arabia | (B) India |
| (C) United States | (D) France |

Q.10 In Fiji's historical electoral system prior to constitutional reforms, why was the principle of 'one person, one vote' violated?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) The vote of an indigenous Fijian had more value than that of an Indian-Fijian | (B) Only tourists were allowed to vote |
| (C) Votes were cast by throwing stones into a river | (D) Nobody was allowed to vote after turning 30 |

Q.11 In Zimbabwe, Robert Mugabe led his party ZANU-PF to repeated election victories until 2017, but the country was not considered a true democracy because:

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) The government harassed opposition workers, suppressed independent media, and altered laws to increase presidential powers | (B) Zimbabwe had no agricultural land |
| (C) Elections were held every single month | (D) The country did not have a currency |

Q.12 Which of the following is a major argument IN FAVOR of democracy as a superior form of government?

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|---|--|
| (A) It is more accountable and responds better to the needs of the people | (B) It allows a single dictator to make hasty decisions without discussion |
| (C) It guarantees that leaders will never make mistakes | (D) It eliminates all forms of poverty instantly |

Q.13 Economist Amartya Sen observed that the catastrophic Chinese famine of 1958–1961 did not occur in democratic India because:

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|---|--|
| (A) India had a multi-party system, free press, and political opposition that held the government accountable for food distribution | (B) India produced ten times more wheat than China |
| (C) India had no rural population | (D) Monsoon rains never failed in India |

Q.14 How does democracy improve the quality of public decision-making?

- (A) Decisions involve consultations, multi-perspective debates, and checks that reduce rash or irresponsible actions
- (B) Decisions are made instantaneously by one individual without consulting anyone
- (C) It bans all meetings and public hearings
- (D) It transfers all lawmaking to military officers

Q.15 How does democracy provide a peaceful method to resolve sharp social conflicts and diverse interests?

- (A) No single social group is a permanent winner or permanent loser; everyone learns to coexist through negotiation
- (B) The majority community is permitted to wipe out minority groups
- (C) All cultural differences are outlawed by royal decree
- (D) Citizens are forbidden from expressing opinions

Q.16 Why is democracy considered to enhance the dignity of individual citizens?

- (A) It recognizes political equality, ensuring the poorest and least educated have the same fundamental status as the richest
- (B) It gives rulers the right to treat citizens as subjects
- (C) It provides free luxury cars to all citizens
- (D) It prevents citizens from holding passports

Q.17 What unique mechanism allows a democracy to rectify its own governance errors?

- (A) Mistakes cannot stay hidden for long due to public debate, and voters can change the ruling leaders in subsequent elections
- (B) Rulers are legally protected from all criticism
- (C) The Supreme Court can abolish all elections
- (D) Citizens are jailed for pointing out government policy failures

Q.18 Which of the following is commonly cited as a real challenge or drawback of democratic politics?

- (A) Instability due to frequent changes in political leadership and delays caused by lengthy deliberations
- (B) Total absence of public speech and political parties
- (C) Rule by a hereditary monarch without consultation
- (D) Permanent ban on judicial review

Q.19 In ancient Greek city-states like Athens, citizens gathered directly in assemblies to vote on every law. This form of democracy is called:

- (A) Direct Democracy
- (B) Representative Democracy
- (C) Constitutional Monarchy
- (D) Oligarchy

Q.20 Why do modern democratic countries with millions of citizens practice 'Representative Democracy' instead of direct democracy?

- (A) Modern populations are too large, and citizens lack the time, desire, or specialized training to vote on every single administrative rule
- (B) Because representative democracy is illegal under international law
- (C) Because citizens prefer having kings make all decisions
- (D) Because technology prevents people from assembling

Q.21 The democratic ideal extends beyond government institutions. In family or classroom settings, democratic decision-making means:

- (A) Everyone affected by a decision has a voice and equal right to be heard through consensus
- (B) The most aggressive person makes all the rules
- (C) Decisions are settled by physical fights
- (D) Children are forbidden from speaking at dinner

Q.22 Which of the following countries successfully transitioned to a multiracial democracy in 1994, ending decades of racial apartheid under Nelson Mandela's leadership?

- (A) South Africa (B) Nigeria
(C) Egypt (D) Kenya

Q.23 The Rule of Law in a democracy ensures that:

- (A) No individual, whether the Prime Minister or an ordinary citizen, is above the law of the land (B) Only lawyers are permitted to make laws
(C) Police officers can punish citizens without trial (D) Rulers are immune from constitutional courts

Q.24 What role does an active, vibrant political opposition play in a healthy democracy?

- (A) It questions government policies, highlights shortcomings, and offers alternative policy solutions to the public (B) It violently overthrows the government during every session
(C) It votes blindly in favor of all government bills (D) It arrests government ministers without judicial warrants

Q.25 In summary, what is the ultimate strength of democracy compared to all other forms of government?

- (A) It may not be perfect, but it is the only system that allows citizens to freely correct their rulers and preserves human rights peacefully (B) It guarantees that every citizen becomes wealthy overnight
(C) It eliminates all human disagreements and creates uniform opinions (D) It prevents all bad weather and climatic disasters

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET A)

01 (A) (B) (C) (D)	02 (A) (B) (C) (D)	03 (A) (B) (C) (D)	04 (A) (B) (C) (D)	05 (A) (B) (C) (D)
06 (A) (B) (C) (D)	07 (A) (B) (C) (D)	08 (A) (B) (C) (D)	09 (A) (B) (C) (D)	10 (A) (B) (C) (D)
11 (A) (B) (C) (D)	12 (A) (B) (C) (D)	13 (A) (B) (C) (D)	14 (A) (B) (C) (D)	15 (A) (B) (C) (D)
16 (A) (B) (C) (D)	17 (A) (B) (C) (D)	18 (A) (B) (C) (D)	19 (A) (B) (C) (D)	20 (A) (B) (C) (D)
21 (A) (B) (C) (D)	22 (A) (B) (C) (D)	23 (A) (B) (C) (D)	24 (A) (B) (C) (D)	25 (A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET A)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.1	(A)	Abraham Lincoln famously defined democracy as 'government of the people, by the people, for the people' in his Gettysburg Address.
Q.2	(A)	A fundamental feature of democracy is that the final decision-making power must rest with those elected directly or indirectly by the people.
Q.3	(A)	A democratic election requires that voters have genuine choices between competing political alternatives, and incumbents face real accountability.
Q.4	(A)	Universal Adult Franchise guarantees that all adult citizens, regardless of gender, wealth, caste, or race, enjoy equal voting power.
Q.5	(A)	Democratic governance operates under the 'Rule of Law', requiring the state to respect institutional checks and constitutional civil liberties.
Q.6	(A)	In Pakistan under Musharraf's Legal Framework Order (2002), elected representatives lacked supreme power; decisions were dominated by the military council.
Q.7	(A)	Before contesting elections in China, candidates must seek approval from the ruling Communist Party, denying voters any real competitive choice.
Q.8	(A)	Although elections took place, the PRI monopolized state machinery, compelled schoolteachers to campaign, and manipulated polling booths.
Q.9	(A)	Saudi Arabia granted women the right to vote and contest only in municipal elections starting in 2015.
Q.10	(A)	In Fiji, the electoral system assigned unequal weight to votes, where an indigenous Fijian's vote counted more than an Indian-Fijian's vote.
Q.11	(A)	Mugabe's regime used state-backed intimidation, banned peaceful protests, and censored news, proving that mere popularity does not guarantee democracy.
Q.12	(A)	Democracy is based on consultation and discussion, making the government accountable to the electorate and preventing neglected famines.
Q.13	(A)	Sen demonstrated that no major famine has ever occurred in a functioning democracy with a free press and opposition criticism.
Q.14	(A)	Democratic decision-making involves broad discussion among many people, allowing mistakes to be identified and rectified before laws are enacted.
Q.15	(A)	In a diverse country like India, democracy provides a peaceful framework where different communities can accommodate each other without violence.
Q.16	(A)	In a democracy, citizens are not subjects of an absolute ruler; they are the sovereign masters of their own collective destiny.
Q.17	(A)	Democracy has self-correcting mechanisms: mistakes are publicly debated, and if rulers refuse to reform, electors can vote them out of office.
Q.18	(A)	Common criticisms of democracy include political instability from changing coalitions and procedural delays caused by extensive legislative deliberations.
Q.19	(A)	Direct democracy involves all citizens gathering directly to deliberate and decide laws, feasible only in small city-state populations.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.20	(A)	With massive populations, modern nation-states elect representative lawmakers to debate and administer public policies on behalf of the citizenry.
Q.21	(A)	A democratic mindset applies to families, schools, and workplaces wherever decisions are made through mutual respect, dialogue, and consensus.
Q.22	(A)	South Africa ended apartheid in 1994, drafting one of the world's most progressive democratic constitutions ensuring equal rights for all races.
Q.23	(A)	The Rule of Law ensures legal equality: everyone is subject to the same laws administered by impartial courts.
Q.24	(A)	The opposition keeps the government in check, scrutinizes budgets, defends public interests, and prevents executive authoritarianism.
Q.25	(A)	Democracy allows citizens to participate in self-governance, protects personal freedom, accommodates diversity, and permits peaceful reform.